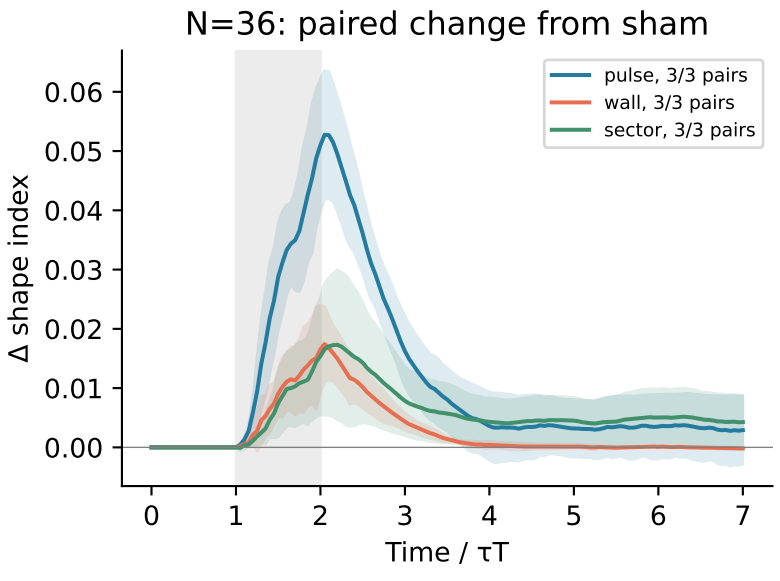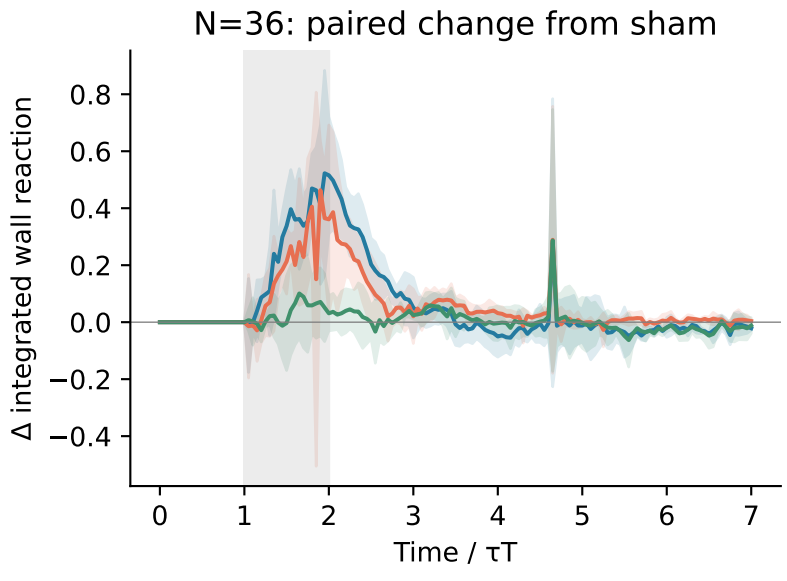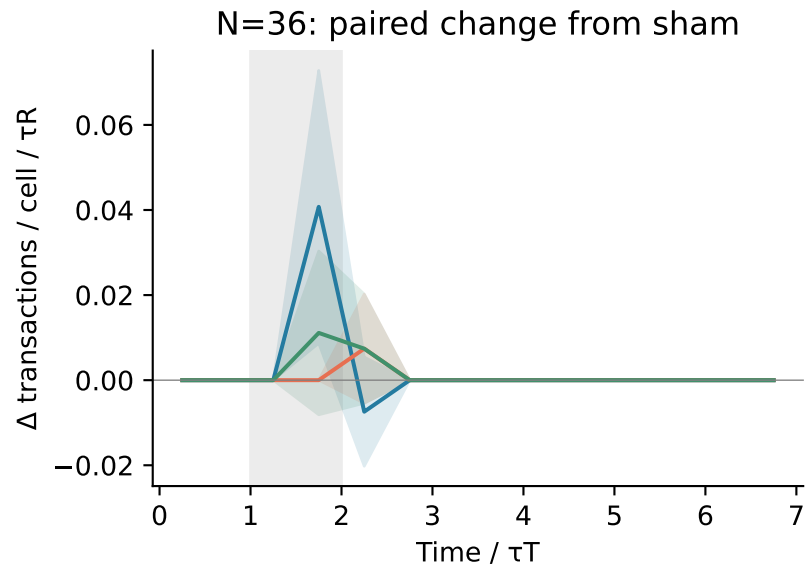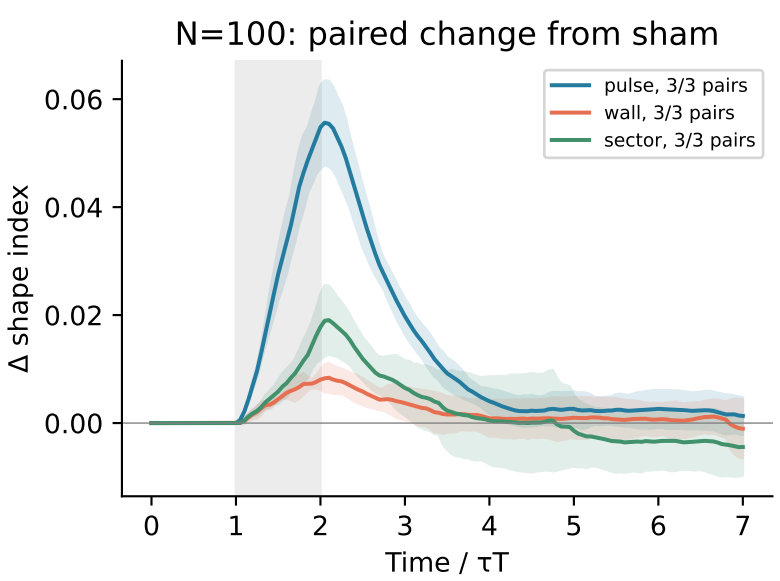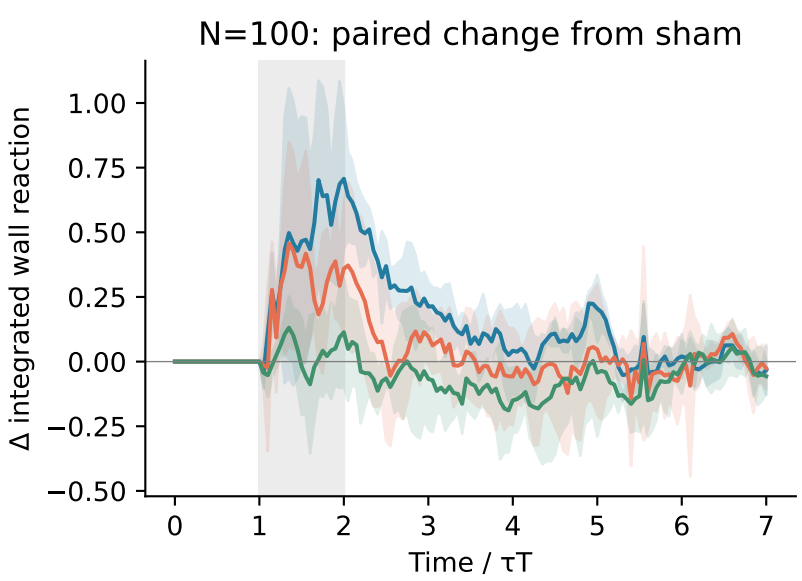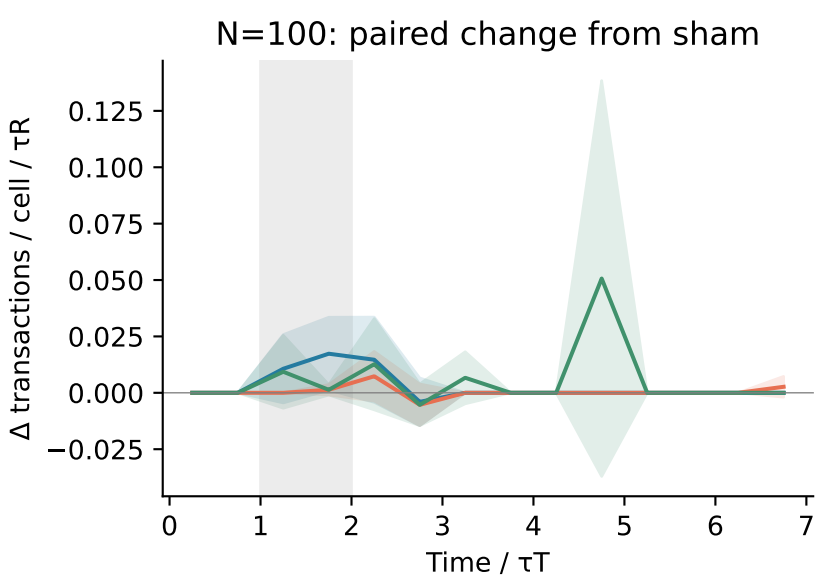Uniform and localized activity pulses, paired against a sham